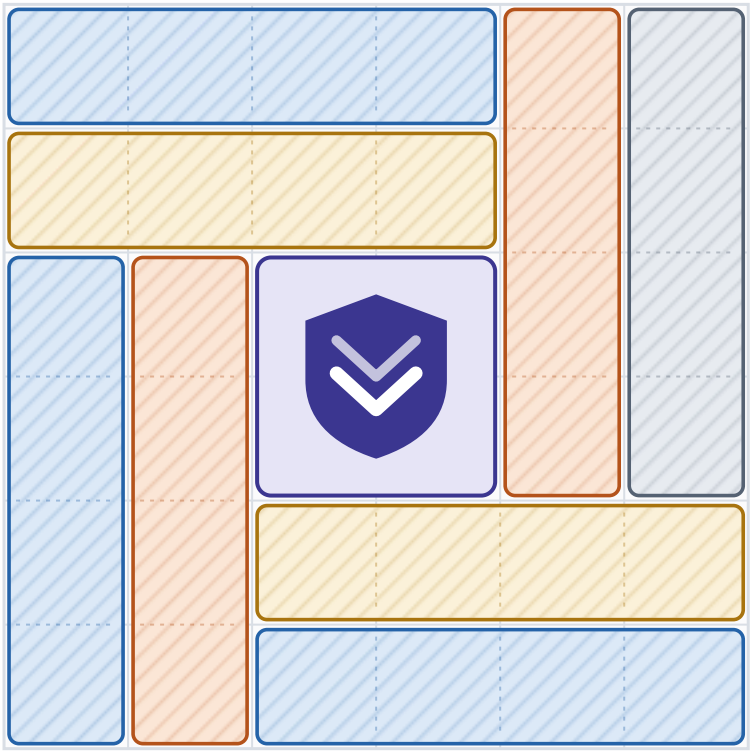
CONCEPT BOOK · PARTS 1–3

Calling Card Tiles
Concepts

Tile-laying games that mix **calling cards** (long 1×4 banner tiles) with **emblems** (2×2 square badge tiles).



Calling card
a 1×4 banner

Emblem
a 2×2 square

A 6×6 board filled perfectly: one emblem in the middle, eight banners around it (a “pinwheel”).

Call of Duty is named only as inspiration. Every rule, name and picture in this book is original. No logos, art or trade dress from any game are used.

Sources: concepts.md (Part 1), concepts-depth.md (Part 2), emblems.md (Part 3) in studio/concepts/calling-card-tiles/

START HERE

One-page summary

RECOMMENDATION

Prototype **Rally Point** next.

It is the head's "better tile-laying game": emblems sit in the middle as triggers. It has the strongest skill signal we have measured, its rules fit on one card, and one ruleset gives a solo daily and a 2-player game.

ALONGSIDE IT

- Write the emblem HQ, modules and patch rule into the **Banner Front** spec.
- Keep **Pinwheel** as the daily-puzzle mode.
- Fold **Keystone Wall** into Running Bond as its rules fix.

PART 3 · BANNERS + EMBLEMS

Rally Point p. 5
Lay calling cards around emblems. A surrounded emblem rallies, and every banner touching it scores.

★ Prototype next

Pinwheel p. 7
Fill the board with banners. Each emblem says how many banners touch it and point at it.

Keep as daily-puzzle mode

Banner Front: HQ & Modules p. 8
Banner Front's battle with a 2×2 emblem HQ, 2×2 module emblems and the patch rule.

Write into the Banner Front spec

Keystone Wall p. 9
Running Bond's gravity wall with emblems as keystones that lock and score.

Fold into Running Bond

PART 1 · FIRST ROUND (BANNERS ONLY)

Running Bond p. 10
Build a wall out of your calling cards. Bridge every joint, match the marks.

Part 1 pick → later daily mode

Pivot p. 11
Swing the banners. Get your card to the exit.

Kept as a daily mode

Crosswise p. 11
One of you lays banners only across, the other only down.

Kept as a versus mode

Broadside p. 12
Every calling card is a warship. Fire from the long sides, ram with a swing.

Not in Part 1's top 3

Banner Keep p. 12
Your deck is your calling cards. Their edges are sockets; make the effects chain.

Not in top 3 · biggest scope

Tilt Stack p. 13
Banners fall wherever down is, and down is wherever you turn your phone.

Not in top 3 · high trademark risk

Panorama Patience p. 13
Deal the strips. Rebuild the pictures.

Better as a reward in Running Bond

PART 2 · DEEPER CONCEPTS (BANNERS ONLY)

Banner Front p. 14
Squads four cells long, guns on one side. Initiative decides who fires first.

Part 2 pick → gets the emblem upgrade

Muster p. 15
Line up troops into charges and walls. Your calling-card elite turns the battle.

Strong second · backup

Spell Rail p. 15
Calling cards on the edge of a match board. Match next to yours to charge them.

Not simulated

Front Campaign p. 14
Banner Front's battles strung into a solo campaign with an army draft.

Best long-term shape · later

THE BASICS

The shapes



Calling card = banner

A **1×4** tile: four cells in a line. It lies across or stands up. It has 2 long sides and 2 short ends.

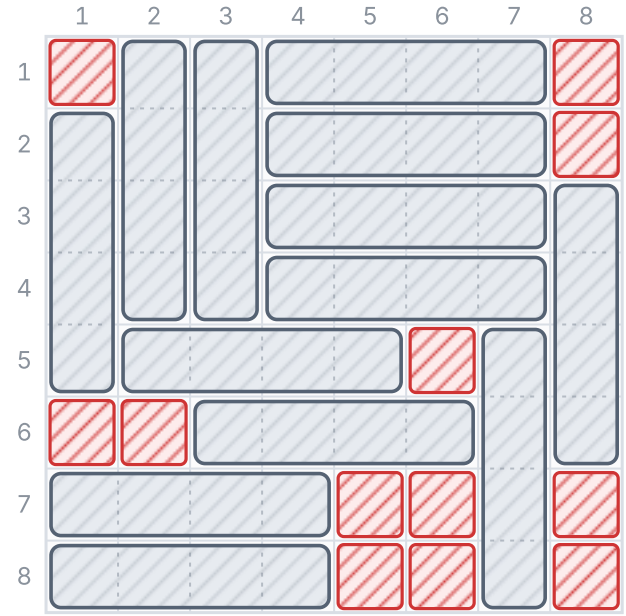


Emblem = square badge

A **2×2** tile. Same area as a banner (4 cells). It has **8 border cells**, 2 per side, so it makes a good hub.

The problem: banners alone leave dead cells

A **dead cell** is an empty cell that no remaining piece can ever cover. Long thin pieces jam: the gaps they leave are mostly 1 cell wide.



A typical jam: random play on 8×8, banners only. **12 dead cells.**

21%
of an 8×8 board is dead after random play (13.7 of 64 cells)

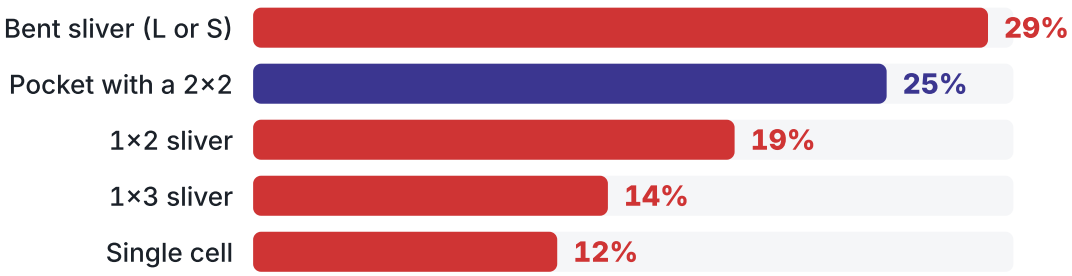
99.7%
of random games strand at least one cell

5.6%
still dead with careful ("tidy") play

Never
a perfect fill on 7×7 or 9×9, whatever you do

Why: banners can fill a rectangle perfectly **only if one side is a multiple of 4** (a known tiling theorem).

WHAT THE DEAD POCKETS LOOK LIKE (SHARE OF ALL DEAD CELLS)



Three quarters of dead cells sit in slivers 1 cell wide. A loose 2×2 emblem can only fill the purple kind.

The fix: the patch rule

THE PATCH RULE

An emblem can go down in one of two ways:

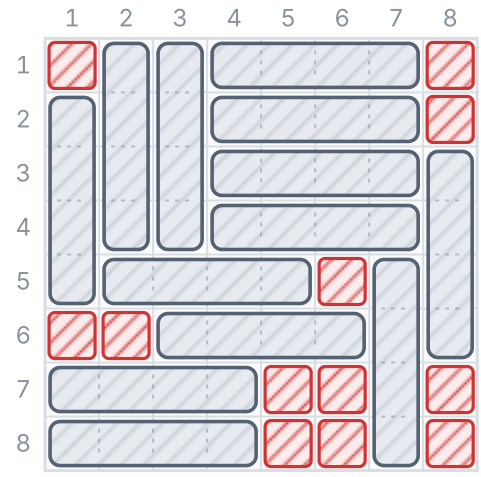
- **Hub:** on any empty 2×2. It can trigger and score.
- **Patch:** pinned over any enclosed gap of **1–4 cells**. The gap counts as filled.

Patching costs you the emblem's hub value, so it is a real choice.

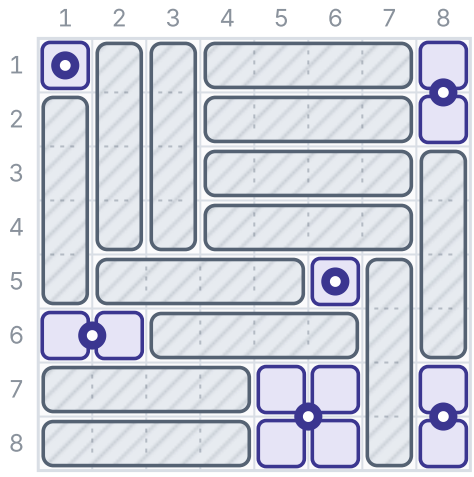
Before and after (8×8 board, share of cells left dead)



Emblems are 25% of the pieces in these runs. With the patch rule, 98% of careful games end with a perfect board. In the docs' words: dead cells fall from **17% to 2%** in random play and to **0%** in careful play.



Before: 12 dead cells.



After: every gap is 1–4 cells, so a patch covers each one. The 2×2 pocket could also take a hub.

Emblems come in pairs on 8×8

An exact search found a **parity lock**. On 8×8, only **0, 2, 4 or 6** emblems allow a perfect fill. On 6×6 and 10×10 you need an **odd** number (1, 3, 5). Players never see this; every layout is checked by the solver.

Mix on 8×8: **10 banners : 6 emblems** recommended · **12 : 4** if banners must dominate



The pinwheel

One centre emblem makes 6×6 and 10×10 fillable. The four arms are rectangles that banners fill cleanly. A 10×10 has **1,018** such tilings.

★ Recommended: prototype this next

PART 3 · EMBLEM DESIGN A

Rally Point

“Lay your calling cards around emblems. When an emblem is surrounded, it rallies, and every banner touching it scores.”

AT A GLANCE

PLAYERS
Solo daily, or 2 players

BOARD
8×8

PIECES
16 tiles: **10 banners + 6 emblems** (12 + 4 in solo). Each tile has 1 of 4 suits. In 2-player, your banners carry your colour frame.

HOW YOU WIN
2-player: most points; a tie goes to whoever completed more rallies. **Solo:** points, +5 for a perfect board, −1 per empty cell.

PLAY TIME
16 placements, about **5–7 minutes**

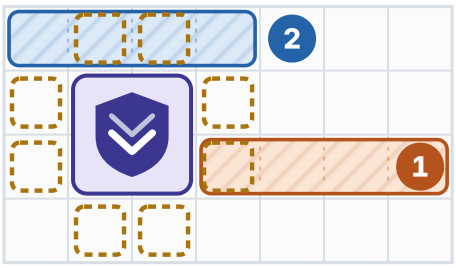
PHONE FIT
Excellent. 48pt cells, 96pt emblems, the 3-tile market under the board

VERDICT ★ Prototype next

HOW A TURN WORKS

1. **Take a tile**
   Pick 1 of the 3 face-up tiles.
2. **Place it**
   Banner: any 4 empty cells in a line. **Emblem:** a hub on any empty 2×2, or a patch over a gap of 1–4 cells (a patch never rallies).
3. **Rally!**
   When all 8 cells around a hub are filled (the board edge counts), it fires and every touching banner scores.

How a rally scores



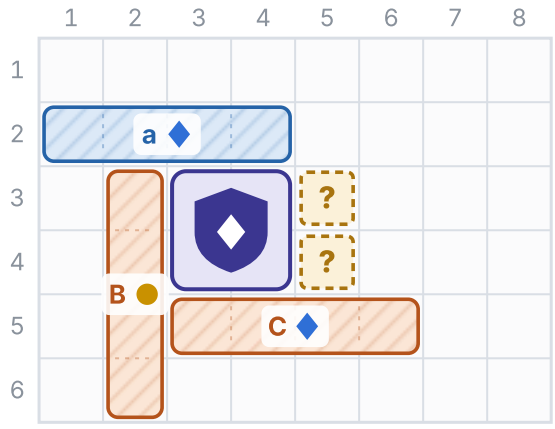
- Each border cell covered by a banner gives that banner’s owner **1 point**, or **2** if the suits match.
- A long side flush with the emblem covers **2** border cells. An end covers **1**, but keeps the far end free to reach a second emblem.
- **2-player:** whoever completes the rally gets **+1**.
- At the end, each un-rallied hub scores its current contacts at face value (no suit bonus, no +1).

The game ends when the stack is empty, or when nothing fits after one market refresh. The rally animation is the beat: every touching banner flashes and its points pop on each segment.

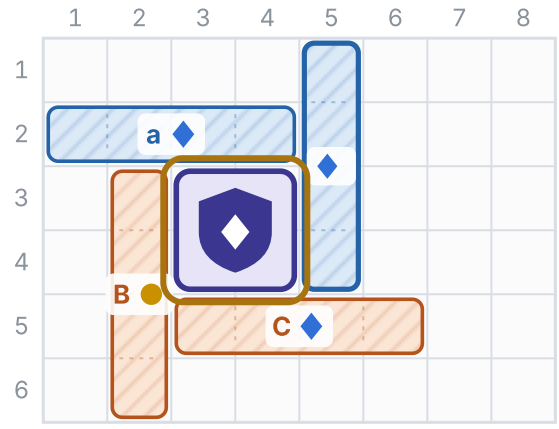
Rally Point: a worked example

Two players. **P1** banners are blue, **P2** banners are orange. The ♦ emblem sits at rows 3–4, columns 3–4. Two cells on its right (**?**) are still open. It is P1's turn, and P1 holds a ♦ banner.

Now



Option 1: close it (new banner in column 5)



P1 scores 9
a: 2 cells × 2 = 4 · new banner: 2 × 2 = 4 · closer +1

P2 scores 6
B (suit ●, no match): 2 × 1 = 2 · C: 2 × 2 = 4

Net +3 for P1

Option 2: half-close

Lay the banner across row 3, columns 5–8. It covers one **?** (2 points pending) and opens a lane. But P2 can then close the emblem with any piece in row 4, for +1 and their own 6.

Option 3: wait

Build a second ♦ hub elsewhere and hope P2 is forced to close this one later.

Closing an emblem always feeds your opponent too. **Who closes, and when,** is the heart of the game.

WHAT THE SIMULATIONS SAY

89–96%
a 1-ply "smart" player beats a greedy one

49 / 42.5
smart mirror: first / second seat %, 8.5% ties

~40 → ~7
legal placements per turn → ones that lead to different results

8.6%
cells dead at the end (smart mirror); patches used about once a game

WHERE THE DEPTH COMES FROM

Hub or patch · Side-on (2) or end-on (1) · Suit matching · Closing tempo · Hate-placing a mismatched suit · Dead cells block rallies

Inspect: a long press on an emblem previews its rally: who gets what if it closed now.

Pinwheel

“Fill the board with banners. Each emblem tells you how many banners touch it and how many point at it.”

AT A GLANCE

PLAYERS
Solo daily logic puzzle

BOARD
10×10, one centre goal emblem on weekdays; 3 solver-checked emblems on weekends

PIECES
2–4 **givens** (greyed-out banners) and a tray of exactly enough banners: 20 or 21

HOW YOU WIN
Every cell filled and every clue exact. The solution is unique. Stars for no hints and under par time.

PLAY TIME
3–6 minutes

PHONE FIT
Good. 10×10 at 39pt cells is the maximum; drag-and-snap with a ghost preview

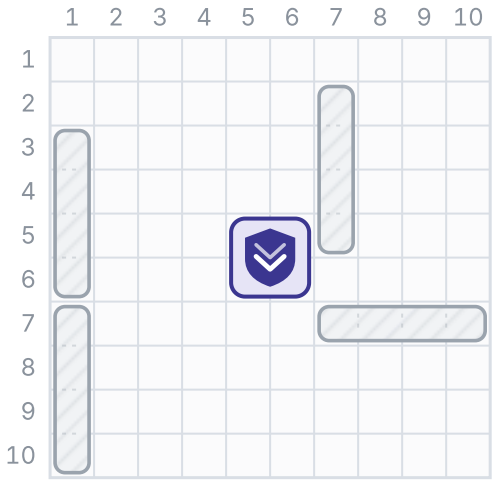
VERDICT Keep as the daily-puzzle mode

HOW A TURN WORKS

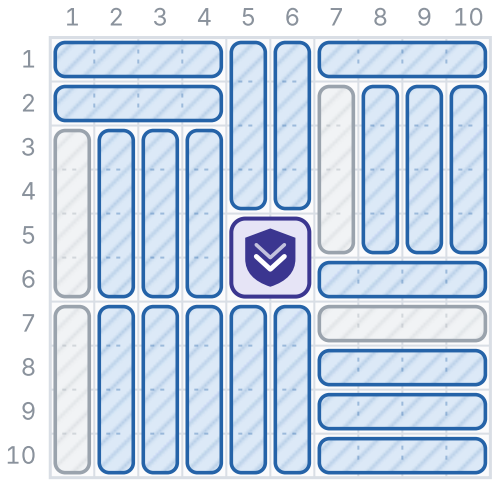
1. **Read the clue**
   Touch = how many different banners touch the emblem. **Point** = how many meet it end-on.
2. **Lay banners**
   Anywhere on the board. Undo is free.
3. **Watch for red**
   Cells that can no longer be covered glow red at once, so the board teaches itself.

Worked example: clue Touch 7 · Point 5

The puzzle: 4 givens



The one solution



Solving starts from the clue: “Point 5” means five banners meet the emblem end-on, so most of its border must be banner ends. Test that against the givens. Grey = givens, blue = banners you place.

1,018
ways to fill a 10×10 around a centre emblem

3.4
givens needed on average for a unique puzzle

20.6
banners the player places

Prize
solve the day’s puzzle to earn its goal emblem (original art)

Banner Front: HQ & Modules

“Part 2’s tile battle (see p. 14), upgraded with emblems.”

AT A GLANCE

PLAYERS
2 (solo against an AI, or pass-and-play)

BOARD
8×8 (was 8×7)

PIECES
Your **HQ is a 2×2 emblem**: your own emblem, centred on your back row. 3 of the 20 deck tiles become 2×2 **modules**.

HOW YOU WIN
As in Part 2: destroy the enemy HQ, or have more HQ HP after the final battle

PLAY TIME
8–10 minutes

PHONE FIT
As in Part 2. HQ and module icons get 96pt badges, which helps.

VERDICT Write into the Banner Front spec, not a new prototype

HOW A TURN WORKS

1. **Draw and choose**
   Draw up to 3 tiles, play 2, discard 1.
2. **Place**
   Units are banners (4 rotations). A module goes on a 2×2 as a hub, or as a patch over a gap of 1–4 cells.
3. **Battle**
   On a Battle order, or when neither a banner nor a module fits anywhere. Initiative 3 → 2 → 1 → 0.

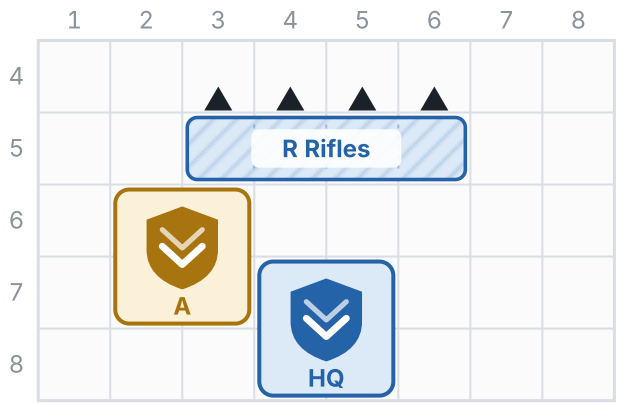
THE HQ

It replaces the 1×4 Command banner. 10 HP (the first player has 11), a Blade on all 8 segments, initiative 0. A square HQ reads as “home” at a glance and gives the enemy 8 segments to aim at instead of 10.

MODULES (2 HP, NO ATTACK)

- **Relay:** touching friendly banners get +1 initiative.
- **Armoury:** Guns on touching friendly banners deal +1 damage.
- **Bulwark:** touching friendly segments ignore Guns.
- **As a patch:** 1 HP, keeps its buff.

WORKED EXAMPLE: BOTTOM OF P1’S SIDE



▲ = Rifles’ Guns on its upper long side. The Armoury **A** touches both the Rifles and the HQ, so the Rifles fire four 2-damage shots.

35% → 2.8%
dead cells when the board-full battle fires: banners only → modules + patch. “Board full” now means actually full.

The enemy’s best answer: a Lancer whose Heavy Gun (2 damage, initiative 3) points at the Armoury. It kills the Armoury before the Rifles fire at initiative 2, so the buff never lands. **Modules become the targets players fight over.**

PART 3 · EMBLEM DESIGN D

Keystone Wall

“Part 1’s gravity wall (Running Bond), with emblems added as keystones.”

AT A GLANCE

PLAYERS	BOARD	PIECES
Solo	An 8×8 wall, built from the floor up	16 tiles: 12 banners (each cell shows a mark ◆ ● ▲ ✚) and 4 keystones, each showing one mark
HOW YOU WIN	**PLAY TIME**	**PHONE FIT**
Score: the usual Running Bond scores, plus keystone locks	8–10 minutes	**Excellent.** The simplest of the four emblem designs.

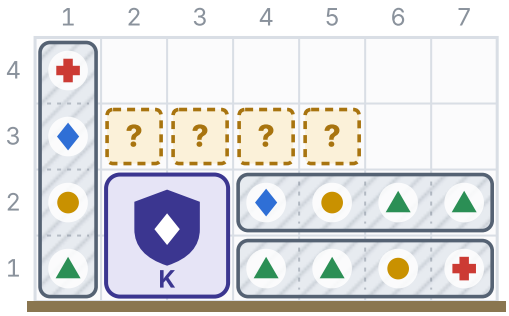
VERDICT **A rules patch for Running Bond, not a new game**

HOW A TURN WORKS

1. **Take a tile**
   As in Running Bond: pick one of the market tiles.
2. **Place it**
   A keystone needs at least one bottom cell supported. Or pin it as a patch over an enclosed hole of 1–4 cells.
3. **Lock**
   When both cells above a keystone and its left and right neighbours are filled, it locks: 1 point per touching banner cell, 2 if the mark matches.

Worked example: one placement, 9 points

Before: K needs its top filled



Lay ◆ ◆ ● ▲ across row 3: K locks



Left	Right	Above	
▲ 1 + ● 1	▲ 1 + ◆ 2	◆ 2 + ◆ 2	= 9 points

K is a keystone with mark ◆. The alternative is to hold K open for a banner with more ◆ marks: the same “now or later” tension as Running Bond, now with a visible target. The patch also replaces Running Bond’s odd “mason’s insert” rule.

WHAT THE SIMULATIONS SAY (GRAVITY 8×8)

8.7% → 0.6%
dead cells in random play: banners only → 25% keystones + patch

29% → 94%
full walls with random play

75% → 100%
full walls with tidy play

PART 1 · FIRST ROUND · BANNERS ONLY

PART 1 · CONCEPT 1 · PART 1'S PICK

Running Bond

"Build a wall out of your calling cards. Bridge every joint, match the marks, and finish the course."

AT A GLANCE

PLAYERS
Solo, with a daily variant (same deck for everyone)

BOARD
An 8×8 wall built under gravity; row 1 is the floor

PIECES
24 tiles; each of the 4 cells shows a mark ◆ ● ▲ ✚. A 3-tile market and 1 objective card.

HOW YOU WIN
Score: Bronze 40, Silver 55, Gold 70. +10 for a perfect wall, −1 per hole.

PLAY TIME
16 tiles, 8–10 minutes

PHONE FIT
High readability. The wall never rotates, so it reads the same in portrait and landscape.

VERDICT Part 1's pick; Part 2 made it a later daily mode

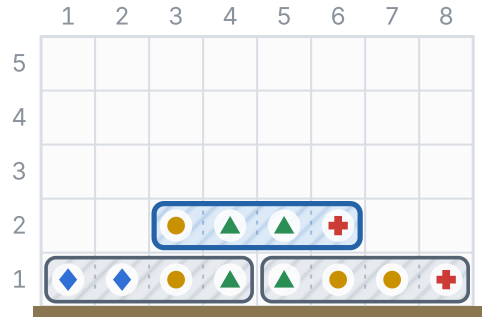
HOW A TURN WORKS

1. **Take a tile**
   Take one of the 3 market tiles.
2. **Rotate and lay it**
   4 rotations. Across: 2 of its 4 cells must be supported. Standing up: its bottom cell must be supported.
3. **Score now**
   Match +1 per same-mark contact · **Bond** +2 for bridging a joint · **Course** +3 per row completed.

Worked example: a sure +5, or a hub for later?

The floor holds ◆ ◆ ● ▲ and ▲ ● ● ✚. The market offers ● ▲ ▲ ✚, ▲ ▲ ✚ ● and ✚ ◆ ◆ ●.

Option 1: ● ▲ ▲ ✚ on row 2, columns 3–6



Bridges the joint: Bond +2. Three matches below: +3. **Total +5.**

Option 2: ▲ ▲ ✚ ● standing in column 8



+0 now (its bottom ▲ sits on a ✚), but it spans rows 2–5: up to 4 later tiles can touch it, up to +4 more.

A sure +5 now against a hub for later. **That is the game.**

35% → 14%
perfect walls: random → greedy players. Point-grabbing leaves holes.

4 marks
is the sweet spot: enough matches to reward, enough misses to matter

Collection
the finished wall is a gallery of your cards (Wall of Fame)

Pivot

Kept as a daily mode

“Swing the banners. Get your card to the exit.”

AT A GLANCE

PLAYERS
Solo daily puzzle

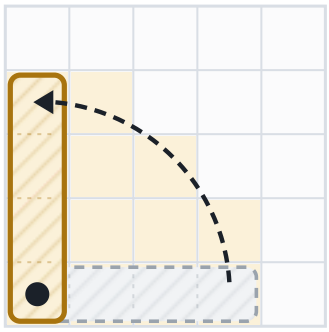
BOARD
7×7, one exit cell on the edge

PIECES
About 6 bars; one is the gold **key bar** (your featured card)

HOW YOU WIN
Key bar covers the exit. Stars at par, par+3, any solve.

PLAY TIME
2–5 minutes

PHONE FIT
Square board: same in portrait and landscape



A swing turns a bar 90° about an end. It sweeps a **wedge of 13 cells** (shaded), which must be empty.

HOW A MOVE WORKS

1. **Pick any bar**
   One bar per move.
2. **Slide or swing**
   Slide 1 cell along its length, or swing 90° about either end.
3. **Reach the exit**
   Get the key bar onto the exit cell.

The wedge is the game: with it, 55% of random 7×7 layouts are solvable and need 10.8 moves on average (up to 25). Without it, puzzles are trivial.

Crosswise

Kept as a versus mode

“One of you can only lay banners across, the other only down. Hold the phone your way.”

AT A GLANCE

PLAYERS
2: Landscape vs Portrait

BOARD
9 rows × 8 columns with 11 star cells

PIECES
Bars, in your own orientation only

HOW YOU WIN
Most stars covered. A tie goes to the last player to place.

PLAY TIME
5–8 minutes

PHONE FIT
Pass-and-play: each player holds the phone their way

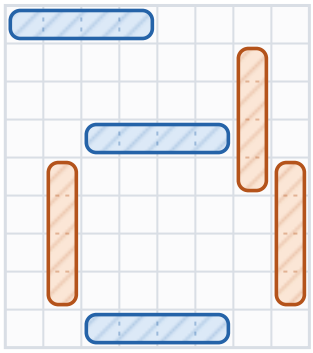


Illustration only: blue bars lie across, orange bars stand up. Stars not shown.

HOW A TURN WORKS

1. **Place bars**
   Landscape places 1 bar, then 2 each per turn: L, PP, LL, PP...
2. **Cover stars**
   Each star a bar covers scores 1.
3. **Stuck? You’re out**
   The other player keeps going until they are stuck too.

On the 9×8 board with the 1-2-2 order, a greedy AI split 50% / 50% (80 games). Board shape is the balance lever: tall boards favour Portrait.

Broadside

Not in Part 1's top 3

"Every calling card is a warship 4 cells long. Fire from the long sides, ram with a swing."

AT A GLANCE

PLAYERS	BOARD	PIECES
2 sides (solo needs an AI)	10×10 sea	4 bars per side. 10 hit locations per tile; ends take double damage.
HOW YOU WIN	**PLAY TIME**	**RISKS**
Sink the enemy flagship, or 3 ships	15–20 minutes	Heavier rules, AI cost, the longest session

EACH BAR TAKES 2 ACTIONS FROM

1. **Advance**
   Slide 1 cell along its length.
2. **Swing**
   Pivot 90° about an end. Enemies in the wedge are rammed.
3. **Fire**
   A broadside hits up to 3 cells out; a bow shot from an end hits a line of 5.

The "aha": swing to ram, and end the turn showing the enemy only your 1-segment bow.

Banner Keep

Not in top 3 · biggest scope

"Your deck is your calling cards. Their edges are sockets. Place them so the effects chain."

AT A GLANCE

PLAYERS	BOARD	PIECES
Solo roguelite	A 6×6 keep	Your deck. Each card has a long-side effect and an end effect.
HOW YOU WIN	**PLAY TIME**	**RISKS**
Clear 3 acts, about 12 fights	25–40 minutes per run; 5-minute fights	A crowded genre; lots of content and balance work

HOW A TURN WORKS

1. **Draw and place**
   Draw 5, place 3 on the keep.
2. **Resolve chains**
   Long-side effects trigger side neighbours; end effects trigger the tile at the tip.
3. **Fight and draft**
   Beat the wave, draft a new card, move on the map.

The "aha": rotate the Spark card upright, and its end effect fires the Doubler, which fires everything.

Tilt Stack

Not in top 3 · high trademark risk

“Banners fall wherever down is, and down is wherever you turn your phone.”

AT A GLANCE

PLAYERS	BOARD	PIECES
Solo, real-time	An 8×12 well	Falling banners
HOW YOU WIN	**PLAY TIME**	**PHONE FIT**
Survive, or score, in a 3-minute round	3 minutes	Risky: orientation lock and motion fatigue. Needs a rotate button.

HOW A TURN WORKS

1. **Steer**
   Rotate the banner as it falls.
2. **Cash in**
   3 banners of the same series touching along their long sides vanish. No line clears.
3. **Gravity turns**
   Every 30 seconds (or on a button) down turns 90° and loose banners slide.

The falling-block trademark risk is highest here.

Panorama Patience

Better as a reward in Running Bond

“Deal the strips. Rebuild the pictures.”

AT A GLANCE

PLAYERS	BOARD	PIECES
Solo	A 4-column tableau	4 square pictures, each cut into 4 strips: 16 strips, some dealt sideways
HOW YOU WIN	**PLAY TIME**	**PHONE FIT**
Complete all 4 pictures	5–8 minutes	Portrait: a picture is a square column. Landscape: 4 squares in a row.

HOW A TURN WORKS

1. **Deal**
   16 strips into 4 columns, some sideways.
2. **Build**
   Move strips to build each picture top to bottom.
3. **Turn upright**
   A sideways strip is blocked until turned; that costs one of 3 tokens.

Needs art authored as cut squares, so it can’t use existing calling cards directly.

PART 2 · DEEPER CONCEPTS · BANNERS ONLY

PART 2 · CONCEPT A · PART 2'S PICK

Banner Front

"Every calling card is a squad four cells long. Guns on one side, a shield on the other. Let initiative decide who fires first."

AT A GLANCE

PLAYERS
2 (solo vs an AI with 3 levels, or pass-and-play)

BOARD
8 wide × 7 deep, square grid. Each side starts with a 1×4 Command banner.

PIECES
20-tile deck each, the same for both players in ranked

HOW YOU WIN
Destroy the enemy Command, or have more Command HP after the final battle

PLAY TIME
About 7 turns each, **8–10 minutes**

PHONE FIT
Medium: 10 icons per tile; needs a battle preview overlay

VERDICT Part 2's pick; now gets the emblem upgrade (p. 8)

HOW A TURN WORKS

1. **Draw 3, play 2**
   Draw up to 3, play 2, discard 1.
2. **Place units**
   Any 4 empty cells in a line, in any of 4 rotations. Units never move.
3. **Battle**
   On a Battle order or when no 4-cell line is left. Initiative 3 → 2 → 1 → 0; same numbers strike together.



Rifles ×5 · initiative 2 · 1 HP
Gun on all 4 cells of one long side



Brawlers ×3 · initiative 2 · 1 HP
Blades on both long sides



Scouts ×3 · initiative 3 · 1 HP
Blades on both ends, Guns on the 2 middle cells of one side



Lancer ×3 · initiative 3 · 1 HP
Heavy Gun (2 damage) on one end, Shield on the other



Bastion ×3 · initiative 1 · 2 HP
Shields on one long side and both ends, Blades on the other side

instant

Battle order ×3
A battle happens now

Gun: hits the first tile in line · Heavy Gun: 2 damage · Blade: hits the touching enemy · Shield: stops Guns at that segment

55% vs 37%
a 1-ply lookahead AI against greedy (mirror is about 46% each)

19–20%
wins for an AI limited to 2 of the 4 rotations: rotation matters

48 / 45
greedy mirror, first / second %, 6% ties: balanced

Later: Front Campaign Best long-term shape · not the first prototype

"Banner Front's battles, strung into a solo campaign where your army deck grows between fights." Start with a 12-tile neutral army, draft 1 of 3 tiles after each win (new types: Shift, Mortar, Medic), face commanders with one special rule each. A run is 8 battles: 40–60 minutes, or 8 minutes per battle with saves.

Muster

Strong second · backup

"Line up your troops into charges and walls. Your calling-card elite turns the battle: stand it up as a lance, or lay it down as a bulwark."

AT A GLANCE

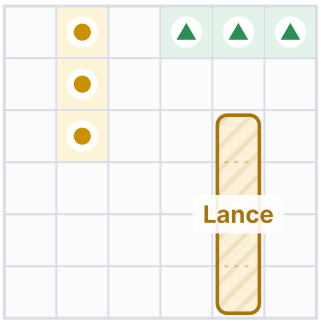
PLAYERS
2, each on their own 6×6 grid

PIECES
16 troops (3 colours), 2 calling-card elites

HOW YOU WIN
Enemy hero (12 HP) to 0, or more hero HP at the turn cap

PLAY TIME
15–20 minutes: too long yet

PHONE FIT
Medium: many small pieces



Illustration, front row at top: **Charge** (3 stacked), **Wall** (3 in a row), **Lance** (upright elite).

HOW A TURN WORKS

1. **Take 3 actions**
   Move, Remove, Call (refill to 16) or Deploy an elite.
2. **Make formations**
   3 same-colour stacked = Charge (fires later). 3 side by side = Walls.
3. **Charges fire**
   Down the facing enemy column: walls absorb, charges clash, the rest hits the hero.

Strongest depth signal of Part 2: a turn planner beats a greedy AI 75% to 21%. Fixes still to test: hero at 10 HP, Call ends your turn.

Spell Rail

Not simulated · third on depth

"A shared match board, and your calling cards are mounted on its edge. Match next to your banners to charge them, and next to theirs to deny them."

AT A GLANCE

PLAYERS
2, plus a solo campaign

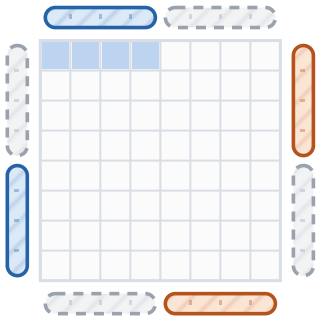
BOARD
Shared 8×8; 8 rail slots of 4 cells

PIECES
4 mana + 1 Strike symbol; 4 ability cards each

HOW YOU WIN
Enemy hero (30 HP) to 0

PLAY TIME
6–10 minutes per fight

PHONE FIT
High readability



Cards sit on the rails (blue = yours, orange = theirs). Matches in the 4 cells next to a card (shaded) charge it, **whoever** made them.

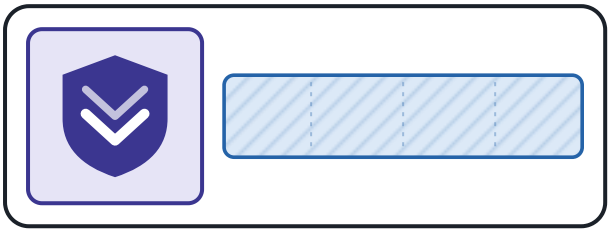
HOW A TURN WORKS

1. **Swap**
   Swap two adjacent symbols to make a line of 3 or more.
2. **Charge**
   Cleared cells next to a card charge that card; you gain mana; Strikes deal damage.
3. **Cast**
   When charge and mana cost are both met. Casting uses your turn.

COLLECTION HOOK

Your player card: emblem + calling card

In Call of Duty a player's identity is an emblem plus a calling card. Our game can make that pair the centre of collecting.



Player Card loadout: pick 1 emblem and 1 calling card. The emblem is your HQ in Banner Front and the face of your hubs in Rally Point. The card is your featured banner. Opponents long-press to inspect both.

Why emblems make collecting more exciting

1. **A second axis.** "I have this card but not its emblem" is a gap that is easy to read, and gaps drive collecting.
2. **Pairings turn two collections into combos.** Each new unlock can complete something you already own.
3. **The emblem is the hero of every rally.** The 96pt badge gets the big animation, so a new emblem is *seen*.

Pairings — Objective only

Original emblem and banner pairs made for each other. When a paired banner touches its emblem as it rallies, a unique animation plays and a stamp goes into your **Pairing Book** (silhouettes with unlock hints).

Emblem orders (sets) — Cosmetic

Emblems come in themed orders of 4, each tied to a banner series. Complete both to unlock a board theme and frame.



"Order of the Wolf: 2 of 4 emblems, 3 of 5 banners"

Emblem ranks — Cosmetic

★★★☆☆ An emblem gains a star each time it rallies or locks, 1 to 5 stars. "Rally with 20 different emblems" rewards breadth.

Daily prize emblem — Cosmetic

Solve the day's Pinwheel to earn its goal emblem: a chase earned *in this game*.

Rally mosaic — Cosmetic

A finished Rally Point board is a mosaic of your banners around your emblems, shareable as an image.

Call of Duty loop — Hypothetical link

Unlock an emblem in CoD → it becomes a hub face here → own the matching calling card too, and its Pairing slot lights up.

Fair play: an emblem's gameplay (suit, module type) comes from a balanced neutral table hashed from its ID. Ranked play uses neutral sets; your collection only skins them. Until there is an agreement, prototypes use only original art and a mock unlock feed.

SIDE BY SIDE

Comparison

Dots repeat the scores given in the source docs (5 = best; for prototype cost, 5 = cheapest). Part 3 was not scored with dots, so its table shows the simulation summary instead.

PART 3 · BANNERS + EMBLEMS (SIMULATION SUMMARY)

Design	Board	Dead cells	Placements per turn	Skill signal	Session
Banners only (baseline)	8×8	21% random / 5.6% tidy	27–29	tidy play quarters the dead cells	—
★ Rally Point	8×8	8.6% (smart mirror)	38–42 (about 7 differ)	**smart beats greedy 89–96%**	5–7 min
Pinwheel	10×10	0 by design (mistakes glow red)	dozens	logic puzzle; grader still needed	3–6 min
Banner Front HQ	8×8	35% → 2.8% with patch	as Part 2	Part 2's battle results apply	8–10 min
Keystone Wall	8×8 gravity	8.7% → 0.6% with patch	9–11	as Part 1	8–10 min

PART 1 · FIRST ROUND

Concept	Rotation matters	Orientation hook	Fun / aha	Collection pull	Proto cost	Session	Trademark risk	Total
Running Bond	●●●●●	●●●○○	●●●●○	●●●●●	●●●●●	10 min	low	**22**
Pivot	●●●●●	●●○○○	●●●●○	●●●○○	●●●●○	3 min	med	**18**
Crosswise	●●●●○	●●●●●	●●●○○	●●○○○	●●●●○	6 min	low	**18**
Banner Keep	●●●●○	●●○○○	●●●●○	●●●●○	●●○○○	30 min	med	**16**
Broadside	●●●●●	●●○○○	●●●●○	●●●○○	●●○○○	18 min	low	**16**
Tilt Stack	●●●○○	●●●●○	●●●○○	●●●○○	●●●○○	3 min	**high**	**16**
Panorama Patience	●●○○○	●●●○○	●●○○○	●●●○○	●●●●○	6 min	med	**14**

PART 2 · DEEPER CONCEPTS

Concept	4:1 and rotation fit	Collection pull	Phone readability	Session	1-week proto cost	Depth signal
Banner Front	●●●●●	●●●●○	medium	8–10 min	medium	lookahead +10–15 pts over greedy
Muster	●●●●○	●●●○○	medium	15–20 min	medium	planner 75% vs greedy
Spell Rail	●●◐○○	●●●●●	high	6–10 min	medium	not simulated
Front Campaign	●●●●●	●●●●◐	medium	40–60 min run	high	inherits Banner Front
Running Bond	●●●●●	●●●●●	high	8–10 min	low	perfect walls 35% → 14% (greedy)

A half dot means the doc gave a range (Spell Rail fit "2–3", Front Campaign pull "4–5").

YOUR CALL

Four open questions

Each question lists the options from Part 3. The recommended one is highlighted.

1 What do we prototype next?

RECOMMENDED **(a) Rally Point.** The hub tile-laying game, with a solo daily and 2 players.

(b) Banner Front with the emblem upgrade.

(c) Pinwheel daily puzzle.

2 Emblem size and the hole rule

RECOMMENDED **(a) 2×2 emblems with the patch rule.**

(b) 2×2 emblems with no patch; dead cells just cost points.

(c) Add 1×1 “pins” as a separate filler piece.

3 Mix on an 8×8 board

RECOMMENDED **(a) 10 banners : 6 emblems.** The most decisions.

(b) 12 : 4, so calling cards clearly dominate.

(c) 8 : 8.

4 How much may collected emblems affect play?

RECOMMENDED **(a) Art, Pairings and ranks only.** Gameplay comes from a neutral table.

(b) In casual and solo modes, emblem orders unlock balanced sidegrade module sets.

(c) Collected emblems carry unique abilities everywhere. Not recommended: it is pay-to-win.

If you say yes to Rally Point: the 1-week Godot 4.4.1 plan

Day 1 8×8 board that adapts to portrait and landscape; tile data

Day 2 Placement: market of 3, rotate, ghost preview, dead cells glow red

Day 3 Rally detection, score popups, rally animation, end scoring

Day 4 Right-click / long-press inspect on every tile; rally preview

Day 5 2-player hot-seat, 3 AI levels, seeded solo daily

Day 6 Collection mock: 24 banners, 8 emblems in 2 orders, Pairing Book

Day 7 Web export, iPhone and PC passes, QA, balance log